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Virginia Board of Education, Committee on the Standards of Quality, Wednesday, June 16, 2021

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GdmjTI-I6IE
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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[00:08:53] okay good afternoon welcome to the committee on standards of quality which is a committee of the whole the board you know as many of you were here when we first prescribed the SOQs back in 19 we have undertaken to do sort of an annual review of where we are with the SOQs with the goal of prescribing them again in the fall and dr sale before you speak apparently we noticed uh in the meeting notice

[00:09:32] that we would take public comments so i'm going to first ask to see is there anybody from the public who would wish to comment on the topic of the standards of quality do not all stampede the podium at once you know it's sort of uh discouraging to have waited 15 months to hear public it live and they have absolutely none but i will accept that as the story of my life here okay uh

[00:10:06] then we will move on to the 2021 biennial review the standards of quality revisiting the 2019 prescription and evaluating progress uh dr sale thank you for being with us yes um thank you for having me and it can you pick me up or am i being picked up on the microphone back here okay wonderful um well because this is the first occasion to for me at least to present in person although i have had the opportunity and pleasure to present in front of the board um and it's other committees and in the virtual

setting i i certainly hope that my virtual or i can live up to my virtual predecessor here um but i will reintroduce myself um in the flesh um so i am dr leslie sale i am

[00:10:46] the director of policy with the department of education um and so pleased to be before you today in person and to provide you an overview of the standards of quality and kind of reflect on where we've been where we are now and where we're going so that hopefully we'll facilitate our discussion here moving forward um so we'll get started let's see oh there we go um per usual i like to start the presentations just kind of taking stock um an inventory of what we're going to accomplish today together as a group um and so first and foremost we'll start the discussion um

[00:11:24] by revisiting the mandate that brings us here um and and reflecting on on the duty and authority of the board as it relates to the standards of quality so as president gecker mentioned um the last time that this particular group was formally convened um actually started in in the fall of 2018 but then you know eventually adopted their 2019 prescriptions in the fall of 2019 and so we will we will kind of start with creating that starting line there and that benchmark um and and discuss the work products and and what came of that discussion there in 2019 and then from there obviously we know um that this biennium in particular has been

[00:12:02] jam-packed with with new things in an evolving state of education um and plenty has happened between the last time or since the last time this group has come together um and as we stand here today so a primary goal of the presentation here will be to just kind of reflect and again take stock of all of the things that have happened since 2019 how that how that's had an impact on the standards of quality and of course how that's intersected with the work and the prescriptions that you all put forth in 2019 and reaffirmed in 2020. some of the actions that we will talk about over the course of the last two years are initiated by general assembly action so there have been a

[00:12:41] and a number of pieces of legislation that have impacted the standards of quality. But plenty has happened in the biennium outside of the general assembly sessions as well. We know there have been multiple JLARC studies that have implicated the agency, as well as a number of commissions and committees that have come together to discuss topics of critical relevance to the standards of quality.

[00:13:01] And so we'll take a look at both the legislative perspective as well as those other inputs that might be worthwhile for us to consider in this discussion. and of course taking 2019 as our benchmark and our starting line we will figure out how we build on the foundation and the work that we've done over the last two years to chart our course forward and use that new information to think about how we might put forth some prescriptions for the 2020 biennial review or excuse me 2021 biennial review or even future iterations of reviews so we can

[00:13:33] think about this in two four six eight year increments here and really think forward so just to start us off with a quick review of the standards of quality um i know many are veterans to this process and and know the standards of quality well but it's always helpful to just kind of get our footing on on what we're working with and and how we got the authority to to do so um so really the reason that we're here today is the constitution of virginia um so article 8 section 2 of the constitution um tasks the board of education with prescribing or from time to time

[00:14:10] reviewing and prescribing the standards of quality for public education in Virginia and this is of course also codified in the code of Virginia and that actually happened back in the 1980s and so oftentimes when you reference the standards of quality you'll hear them referenced in context of the code

of Virginia but what that really means and broadly speaking what the standards of quality are are really the the foundational component of our public education system here in virginia and it's really our expectation and our kind of common baseline for how we provide and maintain a quality educational program in virginia and you can see in that third bullet there as it

[00:14:50] talks about how this is codified in virginia it really touches on a range of programmatic and topical issues so it's everywhere from instructional programs which we often talk about with the standards of learning to our staffing ratios to how we're evaluating teachers and even our local school board policies so thinking about all of those pieces of the puzzle that we need in place to implement a quality program of education in virginia and i think we often also think about these as inputs um so in our next conversation with the standards of accreditation we'll reflect on how we measure outcomes and how we hold school divisions accountable for student achievement and

[00:15:27] growth and continuous improvement but the standards of quality are kind of not necessarily the inverse of that but almost a prerequisite and that these are the things that we know have to go into the system to facilitate those positive outcomes so something important here that's not noted on the slide that the standards of quality are not only critical to us from a programmatic standpoint but they're also really important for driving funding um so as we we the standards of quality it also sets the expectation for the state about our obligation of what we need to contribute to make sure that schools are able and equipped to you know provide those staffing ratios and

[00:16:04] instructional programs that we have deemed as a necessary component of a quality educational program in virginia so the constitution as i noted um asked the board to to review and look at the standards of quality from time to time and it's the code of virginia that has us coming together here again on a two-year basis so that's where we get that timetable for the biannual review and again while we're while we're formally convened here in 2021 but of course as president gecker said um there's always opportunity for the board to reflect on this on a regular annual

[00:16:35] basis so in 2019 our last benchmark here um per its constitutional responsibility the board came together to prescribe the standards of quality in 2019 and that was based on almost a year's or over a year's worth of work um so there was a lot in terms of public comments um going out into the field talking with practitioners um advocacy organizations um really folks from across the board um to put together those prescriptions like that came together again in 2019 um and aside from

[00:17:10] the you know the board meeting its constitutional authority um it wasn't a routine year in 2019 this was a an exceptional year in many cases um one of them being just the scale of the work um and the types of prescriptions that were put forward in 2019 and i think the reason for that coincides with a few different things that were happening with the board um so you all had just put forward your comprehensive plan in 2018 which established three core priorities for you all as a board so it was an opportunity to kind of reflect what you wanted to see done into some action and some policy recommendations and you had also recently convened the special committee for evidence-based

[00:17:47] policy making and so these came together and for i guess you could say it as an opportunity for us to look at the standards of quality a little bit more comprehensively and holistically that then had been done in years prior. So it was, again, the scale of the work that happened in 2019 was very robust.

[00:18:05] And a big change that also happened in 2019 was how we talk about the standards of quality in terms of the board's role and responsibility. So something you all did is went beyond evaluating the

substance of the standards, but the board's responsibility and putting forward those.

[00:18:21] And so you'll see a shift in the comments around the standards of quality in 2019, starting to think about them not as recommendations the general assembly but as the board fulfilling it prescribed the standards of quality which again is its constitutional duty and authority to do so so it's really kind of asserting the board's role as experts in the field and folks who are well positioned and well poised to comment on what the quality of a public education system in Virginia really looks like so since then we've had two years where the the general assembly has received the the standards

[00:18:59] quality from the board had a chance to reflect um and implement some of them um we can you know we'll talk more about what has happened from the general assembly perspective in the coming slides uh but a bit of a spoiler alert we haven't fully realized our 2019 prescriptions yet so there's still certainly more work to be done but i think you'll you'll be pleased with some of the progress that we have made um in the standards of quality space so prescriptions from the 2019 by annual review of the standards of quality i know you all probably can recite all of these in your sleep but we will quickly revisit all of them so we're all familiar again where we're starting from with

[00:19:39] 2019 as our benchmark here sorry i'm navigating two sets of slides here so let me know if i get get off kilter on either one uh the first one here is the equity fund and of course all of the prescriptions that you all put forth in the standards of quality space are are significant and substantive but this is certainly one of the the bigger ones and thinking about how we direct specifically financial support to those students and school divisions most in need of it and so in doing so it was really thinking about the current funding models for things

[00:20:15] like the at-risk add-on program which is in the budget the prevention remediation intervention programs which is also set out in the budget and looking at how those calculated who's getting what money and and what scale and degree um and really kind of correcting for almost a lack of variation in what some school divisions are seeing um regardless of of you know they're they're free the population of free and reduced lunch status and some of the other things that we know indicate an increased need for additional financial support to really be able to support the students that are in their community so the equity fund actually consolidated the at-risk add-on and the prevention

[00:20:52] remediation and intervention fund to allow for again that funding to be directed to the right places and making sure those school divisions that need it the most and need the supports for you know serving their students both academically and outside the classroom are getting those funds there and also provided a little bit of flexibility and how those funds can be used so making sure that all of those services and all of those things like prevention and remediation are still being provided but also recognizing that you know teachers in the classroom and the quality of your instructors and how you're matching your teachers with your students are also important variables there so looking at that a little bit more holistically the second

[00:21:31] recommendation was the k3 class size reduction and this is an opportunity to make sure our early learners are in small classes and with quality instructors so we know that they're getting the intention and and intervention when appropriate at a very early stage so we're setting them up for success and And it's done by kind of scaling class sizes and ratios of teacher to student based on populations of free and reduced lunch students in the classroom.

[00:21:59] And this is currently an incentive program that is based in the Appropriation Act. But by moving it to the SOQ, as this prescription would do, it's really cementing the importance of that. So we know the Appropriation Act is revisited every year with the General Assembly, but really substantively looked at on a biennial cycle.

[00:22:16] including it in the soq again we're kind of saying that this is a critical importance on an ongoing basis and really want to see it um cemented in that way our teacher and leader our teacher leader and teacher mentor program so this would be combining this this particular prescription is combining both a new recommendation which is the teacher leader program and expanding our current teacher mentor program to make sure that we're supporting teachers and keeping them in the profession so we know that teacher induction and creating an environment of support and really allowing teachers to grow professionally as an important part of retention so building the infrastructure that allows folks to do that was one of the many

[00:22:55] prescriptions that you all put forth there just as a kind of framework for for what you had recommended I'm not actually be creating a staffing structure for the teacher link leader and mentor program to make sure folks were on hand and each of our schools and divisions to provide these resources and supports to incoming teachers or new teachers.

[00:23:16] And that would have been one staff member to 15 first and second year teachers, as well as one staff member to 50 teachers with three or more years of experience. So it was kind of scaled depending on the length of time that your teachers had been in the classroom. And again, making sure that those younger teachers are getting the support that they need.

[00:23:35] Our English Learner Teachers was kind of a two-pronged prescription. It was really one of the big parts was updating the EL teacher ratio to reflect the changing demographic in the Commonwealth. But it also differentiated the staffing depending on the proficiency level of your students.

[00:23:53] So it recognized certain school divisions in certain schools may have varied need in the types and amount of staffing that they have on hand for English learners. And so making sure that the right schools have the appropriate amount of staffing to provide that support.

[00:24:10] Reading specialists. um so we know in the standards of quality already reading intervention services are a mandated kind of service provision of school divisions but reading specialists as a staff member are not so it was making sure that we have the right staff in schools to provide these services and you know the current language certainly recognizes you know the many the many different roles that folks for of folks that can provide these types of services to students and and does create a flexible environment but recognizes that reading specialists play a critical and important role in those intervention services and so making sure again that they are on hand to provide those

[00:24:49] services based on the need demonstrated by assessment rates at the local school division level specialized student support positions so this established a four to 1,000 student ratio for certain support positions which as we know the SOQ being a driver of funding meant that these also were funded as part of the SOQ formula and the reason for doing this so of course right now we do you know set out requirements for support positions not at a specific ratio but that category encompasses everything from administrative positions to maintenance workers to those individuals providing direct services to students

[00:25:27] so wanted to make sure that you know in that bucket and larger bucket and larger category that we were making sure that those direct service provisions were appropriately funded and appropriately resourced because of course we know that there is an increasing need for for folks like school psychologists school nurses school social workers who are doing the support and a lot of the direct service work that that makes such a huge difference for our students outside of the classroom school counselors this is one that we have seen in a few different iterations of the board's SOQ prescriptions and this is one that was actually originally prescribed in 2016 to align with the

[00:26:06] american school counselors association who recommended a one to 250 student ratio for school counselors and one of the big components of this is that school counselors play such an important role in helping us implement the profile of the virginia graduate so as we're thinking about what career track or what college bound track what courses what work-based learning experiences might be meaningful and valuable to a student as they move through the public education system school counselors are important and critical in that work so making sure students have access to that resource elementary school principals again another 2016 recommendation right now

[00:26:44] there's a provision in the standards of quality that if your school is smaller than 299 students you can have a part-time principal but we know principals are more than just academic and instructional leaders they play roles and just managing the day-to-day keep those trains running on time um campus safety a whole host of things and so it's really important to have that person um with with boots on the ground and able to respond and react quickly um to what's happening on their campus so of utmost importance that every school has a principal on hand

[00:27:16] assistant principals um again another 2016 recommendation um and i should actually put an asterisk on that um so not only was this recommended in 2016 this has actually been a a board recommendation since 2003 so this is something that you all have recognized as a priority for for some time but that as the the expanding role of building administrators grows in both you know scale of responsibility and complexity of responsibility more is being put on our principals hence a need for making sure folks are available and each school building but that also you know ends up with delegation to our assistant principals who are playing

[00:27:55] important supporting roles for our principals and providing that building level support and infrastructure there so this would be set at a 1 to 400 ratio and currently in the standards of quality there is kind of a step up scale for for how assistant principals are staffed so again this is creating some consistency and reliability and assistant principals as a resource to the to the building similar to our teacher leader and mentorship programs we also prescribed a principal mentorship program and this is really again you know based on the concept that keeping keeping qualified and talented folks and growing those qualified and talented folks in their roles is of

[00:28:34] utmost importance and principals play a huge role in school climate teacher quality all of that has a trickle-down effect in the the building level so making sure that those principals are well equipped continuing to hone and refine their skills as building level administrators and providing the sources to do so. Because it is not quite as easy to pair a principal with a principal as it is a teacher with a teacher, this particular prescription was actually a state-based position. So having someone at the agency providing some coordination and networking for principals to make sure the right folks were connecting with the right folks to provide those professional development supports.

[00:29:15] And lastly, another state-based position was the work-based learning coordinator. So again, another core priority of a lot of the work that the board's done is thinking about college and career readiness and then of course making sure students are exposed at early and early ages with all sorts of opportunities to hone skill sets try on new things really really find what skill sets they would they want to take on and their interests and so that can be difficult to do just knowing the logistical challenges of building relationships with businesses across communities all of those moving parts that factor in to create successful

[00:29:53] work-based learning environments and experiences for students and then of course we know there's some difficulty in rural areas making those connections when it's harder to come by businesses who can take on interns or provide those work-based learning experiences so having a state-based position would allow a statewide and Commonwealth wide coordination of all of those efforts to make sure every student can be paired with those types of experiences and opportunities i will note before we move into how we've seen some some changes in the 2020 and 2021 legislative session um the board actually in addition to these 11 prescriptions recommended

[00:30:30] um three other items which i'll just quickly note um the first two are related to recession era of provisions and the appropriation act um the first being staffing flexibility so it effectively the the soq that sets staffing ratios it was providing kind of a small adjustment in how school divisions could implement those staffing ratios to provide again a small amount of flexibility recognizing that the fiscal stress that the recession in 2009 and 2010 put on our schools and divisions of course as we move out of the recession you know one of the goals being to see the restoration

[00:31:05] of funding as as available and making sure that we are sending money to school divisions to meet those SOQ ratios knowing that that we've determined them to be again you know a critical part of a quality public education system in Virginia and the second piece is the how support positions are calculated and funded so again as a recession era measure there were you know attempts by the General Assembly and I shouldn't say attempts there was a you know a desire from the General Assembly to be able to provide some again additional flexibility to school divisions and how they meet support positions and then of course you

[00:31:42] know remove some of the financial burden knowing that we were in a recession era and so by removing that it would again provide more money to divisions to support that larger category of support positions and then the last item was improving data collection generally so as you notice a lot of your recommendations touch on staffing and the importance of staffing and making sure you all are well equipped with the data that you need to make educated decisions in that space so again I know we talked about that the 2019 SOQ prescriptions which were again reaffirmed in 2020 have not been fully

[00:32:19] realized but we have seen a lot of progress and a lot of movement in the in the General Assembly space as it relates to the SOQ so we'll highlight just a few of those but first is House Bill 975 and Senate Bill 910 which are both were part of the 2020 session and actually you'll see all of them here from the 2020 session which started a phased and approach to upgrading or updating the the English learner teacher ratios so something of note here that even though we do see an increase and the number of English learner teachers which will increase this coming school year - or increased

[00:32:58] last year since 18.5 and then the coming school year to 20 full-time positions to a thousand students this did not include your recommendation for differentiation and and the types of instruction or

rather the staffing ratio per proficiency level of the students how school 1508 and Senna Hill 880 also took the face-in approach to getting us a little bit closer to the school counselor ratio and where we ultimately landed it was a 1 to 325 student ratio which will be in full or go into the phase of full implementation for the 2021-2022 school year you all may have

[00:33:38] heard some discussion last year when the Appropriation Act or the General assembly revisited the budget based on um you know concerns around covid projections that our interim step was delayed um to account for you know some some you know shortfalls in cash but of course that that since we've come full circle here and recognize that the the resources are available um that the 1 to 325 will be fully funded for the 2021-2022 school year um and lastly while this isn't an soq prescription um i thought it would be a value to note for for you all that household 1388 which was actually an agency bill um eliminated the option

[00:34:17] of triennial accreditation which is in the soq um and really what that was meant to do is that as you all evaluated your accountability system and the standards of accreditation to look more holistically of what about what student outcomes and student achievement um closing achievement gaps um and really not you know hedging everything on on passing rates um that this reflected that change that um if if school divisions or schools were going to be you know rewarded in the space of accreditation by you know being allowed a triennial accreditation review cycle um that should be based

[00:34:49] on a complete picture um and not just the the pass rates for school oh and before actually i will i will go back even though this isn't on the slide here um what i have up here are bills that passed the general assembly uh but something that again is of importance for you all um is that there were two bills that incorporated the entire soq prescription so all 11 prescriptions that you all had put forward um in both the 29 or 2020 and 2021 session and we'll talk a little bit about the evolution of the 2021 bill here in a moment um and both of those bills passed the policy committees

[00:35:25] um so there was support from a policy and programmatic side for those but ultimately they didn't make it out of house appropriations with the funding limitation being really kind of the the hiccup there but um i think important for us to reflect on that they did see movement from a policy and programmatic perspective um senate bill 1257 um this was actually a bill that started as the entire soq um from senator mcclellan um and i think the reason that we see so few bills on this particular slide for the 2021 session was in part because of the the limits on the number of bills um so legislators were being um you know very strategic in how they were using their um the

[00:36:05] number of introduced bills allotted to them but again this one did start as a full soq bill but after negotiation and really kind of honing in on priorities especially in the time of covid um during 2021 um this was paired back to really focus on this those specialized student support positions and what this bill ultimately produced was a new ratio of of specialized student support positions um and and i guess i should start with a new category of um staffing positions to make sure that they were fully funded in the budget and there was an established ratio for these important positions which included school psychologists social workers school nurses and other health

[00:36:45] and licensed behavior personnel so as of this coming year there is the requirement to staff that at three to a thousand and lastly there was budget language that removed that staffing flexibility so we talked about the board having some prescriptions and then some recommendations on things that would support soq work the budget did remove that recession era flexibility for staffing in the second year so as

we approach the 21-22 school year the ratios that are set out in the standards of quality and standard two specifically are in full effect there are no more flexibilities or provisions to provide a little bit of additional space for school divisions

[00:37:22] there other related legislation so this is again not directly related or explicitly related to the the prescriptions you all put forward in 2019 but I think will be of importance and value for us as we continue the discussion this year and in years beyond Senate bill 933 which was passed in 2020 um you are already familiar with this and I think I've heard a few presentations on some of the work to come from this bill now around students with limited or interrupted formal education and this bill really kind of prompts the department and board to

[00:37:58] better understand the student population both in terms of size of demographic as well as the existing supports that we're providing those students so this work is currently underway we have established a statewide definition for what a slave student means with that we can better evaluate who these students are and where they're kind of concentrated across the Commonwealth and then of course the next step from there is understanding how those divisions are providing for support to their students hospital 1653 also helps get at this this discussion around the availability of data especially as it relates to staffing and requires the departments to collect data on the ability to fill school counselor positions and so

[00:38:37] this was kind of hand in hand with the increase in ratio for our school counselors to making sure our supply supply was meeting our demand here and this work is actually due fairly soon so we will have a report on on what that data looks like here forthcoming in the next few weeks which we'll be able to share with you all to reflect on in this work. Household 357 expands our collection of vacancy data to not just instructional personnel but all licensed personnel and support positions so again getting a fuller picture of where our staffing exists and particularly where the holes and stuff and then household 2299 and

[00:39:16] Senate bill 1288 these were bills that were largely drawn from the J Lark study on special education in Virginia which included in a number of provisions related to special education but as we think about the standards of quality task the department with looking at the requirements for the applied studies diploma which is part of the you know is related to the standards of quality as we set out the graduation requirement so the future of the SOQ we've talked about oh yes so I have a couple of questions about the legislation that's

[00:39:52] already passed yes like them now or do you want to after the future discussion you know I I don't have a preference however would facilitate the discussion best for you all so I might defer to President Gecker here if you would like to kind of pause to reflect and take some questions or see the rest of the presentation through and and I don't have a strong preference but just clarifying questions so yeah I think it's okay we're gonna finish the presentation and absolutely we're doing all right okay so again we've we've

[00:40:28] reflected on where we started what's happened or where we've been now and now where we're going as I mentioned there was there was much more to happen in the last few years than just the General Assembly sessions and the legislation that passed in those spaces but we also had those three JLARC studies come through that all implicated the Virginia Department of Education and might provide us some opportunity to think about changes to the standards of quality I think of a particular note for us in this

space is the the JLARC study that was specific to the agency operations and there were actually some reckon recommendations specific to the standards of quality specifically how we

[00:41:06] we measure and evaluate compliance and so resulting from that is budget language that has us doing an SOQ data compliance pilot and looking a little bit more closely at how schools are meeting compliance with the SOQ standards as well as verifying compliance so really asking for some additional evidence to show show supporting information and again supporting evidence is really the best word for it that these every school division in school are meeting their responsibility as it relates to the standards and the second piece which is a little tangential but I think kind of fits into our larger larger picture around how we provide support to schools

[00:41:44] is around our office of school quality and and putting together a plan for how we grow our office of school quality and our school improvement model and I think an important part of that is of course outcomes but also inputs and making sure that the school divisions that we see having trouble or see needing support are also able to meet these standards and so I think that'll help us kind of look introspectively at what what we're asking of school divisions to meet as that baseline expectation of quality and where some of these divisions could provide or need could accept support to get there we

[00:42:22] have some recommendations from the african-american superintendent's advisory council which may be meaningful for us in our discussion the two that are specifically related to the standards of quality and are actually delineated in the memo as such are the equitable distribution of experienced teachers among high and low poverty schools which i should note is a component of the equity fund and then require a culturally responsive and inclusive practices coordinator in every division so that would be you know helping us think through some other opportunities for for staffing requirements at the local school level and then of course there's opportunities for for us to

[00:42:59] revisit outstanding or ongoing discussions that we know have been of importance or interest to the board these are not necessarily indicative of everything that we've talked about over the last few years but um some of the ones that were top of mind for us as we were reflecting on the soq being standards for facilities teacher coaching programs special education staff ratios mathematics specialists and instructional technology of resource teachers especially knowing the evolving role of you know technology and virtual instruction and lastly um just to kind

[00:43:35] of revisit where we are on data collection um kind of in response to one of the board's prescriptions or rather recommendations around additional data collection and additional data especially as it relates to staffing there has been some work in the space as we've seen some in part response to general assembly legislation some in parts responding to jlark recommendations and somat agency initiative here but we will have additional information around compliance from the soq pilot program which we'll be able to share in forthcoming years um an expanded data collection on vacancies which again will incorporate all licensed personnel and support support positions

[00:44:13] teacher race and ethnicity data which is actually now recently available publicly available on the website an exit survey data collected from local school divisions and this is actually an extension of a pilot program that the department was tasked with with putting together several years ago to better understand why why teachers are leaving um either the the profession or their or their um you know buildings or fields or particular positions um and better understanding the trends about that across the

commonwealth so um i believe that's actually hopefully not yeah there we go um at the end of the presentation there um which i think means i can maybe hand the

[00:44:53] mic over to miss holton for for to start their questions if that's the will of president gecker year you're welcome to have the mic i'm not i'm not rushing miss holton so i just had a couple of clarifying questions sure one was on the thank you by the way that was extremely helpful to remind us what we've done before so on the school counselor one we had recommended 250 one to 250.

[00:45:23] yes what the general assembly did was one to 325. yes and that will be implemented this school year 21-22 and if i'm correct but my my recollection is previously where we were was 1 to 450 but was that in the standard or was that just what their estimate there was nothing in the standard before and we were just estimating that we were at one to 450 there was a ratios in the standards of quality but they were scaled based on the size of student population and grade um and i can pull that back up until i don't know if you know i will say though the 1 to 450 was more what practice was

[00:46:03] than what was in the standards but as as dr still mentioned it was more scale based on the size of the school and at one point they also put in ratios based on grade levels so elementary was one level middle with one level and high school was another so to help me understand broad brush the 1 to 325 is significant progress towards our recommended 250 but it's not there yet and the phased in bill doesn't take it beyond the 325 right so the the phased in part of it would

[00:46:36] actually have been a stop gap between what it was before um to the one to 325 but we never ended up implementing that it remained at the 2019-2020 levels um because of the appropriation act so if we if we choose to reaffirm that recommendation this this biennium but for this set of biennial recommendations then the 250 is still not yet met yes there's still more movement to be had there that's one and then the other one i wanted to understand is on the specialized

[00:47:11] support positions we had recommended four to a thousand and the general assembly adopted three to a thousand yes so similarly there's still potentially a gap that we may want to may or may not want to include a recommendation to continue to go get to where we had prescribed before and the other piece of that one i wanted to understand is we had also recommended that the specialized positions be taken out from under the student support cap in the general assembly did they do that yes it was pulled so it is a it's its own staffing category now which means it's pulled out

[00:47:46] from the what would be considered the support position cap so those are funded separately through the SOQ formula as you all had prescribed for the four to a thousand the only discrepancy there is that that additional last staff person since that's only three to a thousand so if I understand that correctly that not only gives divisions more expectations and resources to meet with respect to the specialized positions but it also frees up a little bit of money that was coming in under the student support cap for other support positions yes I believe so and some of the mechanics of how the support position cap and the funding

[00:48:26] side I don't want to mischaracterize but I yes but I believe that would be the case that additional funding would be opened up in that space since those positions are being funded through a separate formula and model unless the cap was also somehow adjusted which we don't think it was yes that would be my understanding but oh okay but certainly something we could confirm and circle back with since again I think the only thing I would add to that is I think it's fair to say that school divisions are

spinning far beyond the sport cap so I don't think it has a practical impact in most at least in most divisions yeah

[00:49:00] yeah and I would agree with that I mean prevailing practice has been that school divisions are going well above and beyond the support caps since that's a little bit of an arbitrary number to some extent so as Dr. Lee mentioned I don't think it really frees up but they do get this specialized support money so that that is the impact but I would not think of it as a huge benefit to the support cap other than reducing the burden should it want to get

[00:49:31] back to not having that cap yeah I just like you if you don't mind you know I look back and saw that that really only three of us here you know were on the board that passed the comprehensive work plan and so if it's okay with the board let me do just a few minutes of where i think we were and how we got to where we are today just you know it's hard as the board changes membership to keep sort of that common theme going and from 17 to you know 21 is a long enough period that we've

[00:50:09] had substantial change in personnel you know one of my goals uh and i think this has been i hope obvious has been that the board not only stay within its lane that is our constitutional and statutory lane as the educational policy body but also do those things that we are supposed to do you know a couple of them make sense to us i hope this one does a couple of them sometimes you know know we have some pushback on like uh you know why are we now approving superintendents why are we certifying superintendents and the answer to that is because the constitution says we're

[00:50:45] supposed to certify the superintendents you know in modern practice is it necessary maybe not but it certainly does put us back to where we're supposed to be in 17 uh we passed a comprehensive work plan that was supposed to run and will run you know from 18 to 23 and the sort of three stated goals and loosely stated goals of that plan were, number one, to figure out how to do equity in the Commonwealth. And, you know, frankly, unfortunately, the equity word has been bandied about so much now and in so many contexts, it may have lost some meaning. But in the context of the

[00:51:24] time, you know, the board was very concerned about every child not having necessarily equal outcome, but equal resources in and those resources necessary to achieve an equal outcome so that every group would be on par with every other group. Loosely stated, and I think the department adopted this, you know, when we can no longer predict outcomes by zip code, we'll know we've achieved equity in the distribution of resources in the commonwealth. And, you know, our goal, just to be clear, is not to bring the top down, but to raise everybody up. So that was sort of

[00:52:02] number one number two was we recognized and there was a lot of press back in the 1718 timeframe about the need for teachers the you know we still have a teacher shortfall and maybe actually exacerbated by the pandemic but certainly in those days we were give or take rough number a thousand teachers short a year in the Commonwealth we understood that teachers were leaving profession if they left at an early you know fairly early uh in their careers and we understood also that uh you know teachers matter to the educational outcomes of our kids and you know frankly when you

[00:52:41] cut through everything that we do our goal is to improve educational outcomes for our children that is really the sum in my view you know of what this board's responsibility is in addition we recognize that building leadership matters it matters because principals relate to their teachers and frankly every study that looks at this indicates that if you take the top two things that are going to matter to educational outcome number one it's going to be teachers and number two is going to be building

leadership and you know how the building leadership interacts exactly they're not sure but it's clear that it matters substantially and number three of course is the

[00:53:20] accreditation piece which the board has really not attacked yet in any significant way we spent a fair amount of time as dr sale mentioned uh researching and i will tell you that when it started there was a belief certainly i believe that what we would come back with were recommendations around social safety nets more counselors more social workers you know putting more resources in the schools and what we ended up with was a very much teacher focused outcome uh the recognition

[00:53:56] you know i like to say you know that the message of the soqs is simply that teachers matter and we built in and we also understand that every teacher is not as effective as every other teacher and if you look at the data kids in poorer schools or kids of lower socioeconomic backgrounds were being taught more frequently by more inexperienced teachers or teachers teaching outside their endorsed areas and if you go to you know what was referred to as sort of the principal recommendation or the principal prescription in our soqs yes it deals with allocating money but really what it is

[00:54:35] is allocating policy and that policy is that uh not that we can force a quote equitable distribution of teachers but we may be able to incentivize teachers of higher teaching effectiveness to lower socioeconomic jurisdictions by paying them more and it was anticipated that the additional money in that standard as we uh you know merge the equity fund would be used to more evenly distribute teaching talent throughout the commonwealth or alternatively if you look at the same standard those jurisdictions could reduce class size continue to use younger or less

[00:55:15] experienced teachers and thereby hopefully achieve the same results and that theme of building up our teachers carries through we have the mentorship program we have the teacher leadership program we want to have mentors for principals to have them be able to run their buildings better and that is has been really the primary thrust of the SOQs as we've moved forward now a little constitutional history and then I'll be quiet and we can I know Anne sort of chuckles when I do this but it's okay I've gotten used to it over the last four years the in 71 you know

[00:55:54] Virginia said Board of Ed you get to prescribe SOQs from time to time subject to revision only by the general assembly uh and for a while that's exactly what happened the board of education prescribed standards of quality those standards interestingly enough were not codified by the general assembly but they were continued on in the uncodified laws of the commonwealth you know indicating that they clearly were temporary and the general assembly frankly did its work in those days and actually modified the standards of quality uh and there was a process in the assembly to carry that out in the 80s the standards became codified and part of that complicated because

[00:56:33] frankly the board wasn't doing its job after a while you know we were not as a board putting forth the recommendations excuse me on the prescriptions and the assembly effectively stepped into the vacuum and took it over and relegated us by statute to the biennial review and recommendation process. Despite that, we still have the constitutional, not only I think right, but also obligation to continue to prescribe SOQs. And those SOQs are then subject to revision only by the General Assembly. If you go back and read sort of the treatise on the Virginia Constitution

[00:57:11] done by Dick Howard, what he says basically is we are in charge of educational standards and the assembly is in charge of the budget and it would be wrong to say to our body you can do whatever you want because that would effectively be a blank check uh but it you know the first shot if you will at the

standards ought to come from us and then meld it you know mold it around the budget by the general assembly and so you know i consider you know the board to be fairly

[00:57:46] bold in 19 when we said, okay, for the first time in basically two decades, we're going to go ahead and prescribe standards of quality. We did it again last year, not on a biannual cycle, but we did it again pursuant to our constitutional, as I think, obligation. And I'm hopeful that we will do it again this year. This meeting is really the first of maybe one or two, maybe more if we need it, to decide whether we're going to make changes to what we prescribed back in 19 and again back in 20.

[00:58:20] You know, and as we move towards September, October, we will go ahead and take a vote on whether, you know, what we're going to prescribe for the coming year. You know, the good news, in my view, and, you know, we talked about this, too, at some length is none of us really believe that they would be adopted.

[00:58:40] What we do would be adopted by the General Assembly. I mean, frankly, the amount of time that gets spent focusing on sort of fundamental shifts is pretty minimal when it comes right down to it. And so much turns on the money and the money here is significant. At the same time, we have clearly laid out a marker.

[00:58:57] And as we're seeing by, you know, the report today, and frankly, if you know, we're not living in caves, we see what's going on in the political environment. people are beginning to adopt our plans as their plans for the future of the Commonwealth.

[00:59:18] And so, you know, it's still my belief that if in 10 years we've gotten to where we think we ought to be, we'll have done pretty well for ourselves and for the kids in the Commonwealth. But that is, I think, where we are, how we got here, and what our purpose is, not just today, but if we, you know, we'll have at least one more committee meeting before we take this to the full board.

[00:59:39] But that's, to me, what we're doing now. I will accept any corrections or comments on that. You know, and with regard to staying in our lane, you know, there's a couple of things that are, you know, presented today. You know, for example, I'm not picking on this one specifically, you know, other than as an example, you know, the divisions, you know, the suggestion that we can change division lines.

[01:00:04] Well, technically true in the Constitution, but the Constitution also says it's subject the criteria set up by the General Assembly. Those criteria today include requiring the consent of the different jurisdictions. So in fact, although it looks like we have that power, as a practical matter, we don't. And so although we can talk about it as if we can do it, the truth is we can't outside our purview. And, you know, I continue to hope that we focus on those things that we can really do that are within clearly within our purview, the agenda and the policy that we can

[01:00:41] move forward. And again, fundamental question always, are the kids better off when we're done? So that's it. Now, any other questions for any questions for Dr. Sale? Thanks for indulging me. Yes, ma'am. Well, President Gecker, I always appreciate hearing history, being reminded of history and also thinking about, you know, the role of the board. So I appreciate your commentary and a comprehensive plan is something actually that I continue to go back to in terms of what we do to help people understand dr shell thanks very much for the presentation i do have a couple

[01:01:15] of maybe it's observation um maybe a question so the action of the general assembly in both 20 and 21 and to mrs holton's um this whole person's question about getting us closer to our goal we are

making progress thinking though about that progress in relation to teacher shortage i i think it's fair for us to at some point um here understand how changes in the teacher ranks

[01:01:52] and support position ranks availability of the supply and demand question right so we're making progress but what does the pipeline look like for teachers who work with l students right we're increasing the number um by standard but what about supply same thing in those support positions you know social workers school psychologists behavior analysts um you know it's one thing to we know that the standard has to be there to begin with but then what are the supports that we have in

[01:02:27] place as a department um in localities frankly to help ensure that we are able to fill the positions to be able to affect students and provide them the supports that they need so that then they can have the outcomes that we you know what i mean so it's like this big circle or a cyclical kind of conversation so i would at some point be interested to know how those things are moving forward and may not be a conversation for today but i just noted yeah i'll i'll respond um i think next month we can bring a a presentation to you on the supply and demand report which gives you the

[01:03:06] information that we do collect i i will tell you uh just before a retirement that we're going to celebrate tomorrow uh we uh initiated some new data collection requirements as it relates to teacher supply and demand and background of teachers and so we'll have even more data next year so i think uh i would consider what we share with you next month to be somewhat interim because i think you'll be really excited to see the level of depth that we're going to be going to in the future. I would just add to that, when we think about this broader supply and demand picture,

[01:03:41] when we think about in some of the areas where progress has been made and ratios have been changed, we are in correct funding positions that had existed because divisions have recognized the need before the state cut off to net, essentially. And then we throw the pandemic in the midst and how those factors into play. We have additional data collection. Some of

[01:04:04] So may I ask a follow-up?

[01:04:25] So then, Holly, are you saying that-- so we do-- does the department collect what that pipeline looks like from our teacher ed programs? Is there a partnership with SHED or others that allows us to do that?

[01:04:42] Yes. I hear a but. Yes, but, as always. So I'll say on the school counselor piece, for example, as the General Assembly was having that conversation, we looked specifically at how many licensure personnel were out there, how many were coming through those degree programs, and in a very high-level way, estimating whether or not the demand was in fact.

[01:05:05] So this is what I was going to be doing. and i would say we have we have better data on graduate trend than in process students related to the data question thank you so much for your presentation um and i just i'm curious because i've heard reference to a data pilot around just how we're tracking and measuring

[01:05:40] sort of progress with the soq and it made me wonder prior to this point in history does that mean that there's been very little data or maybe there's like a lot of data that could be used but whether it's conceptually really tied to understanding how the soqs or the implementation of soqs are happening i'm just kind of curious to appreciate you know without getting into the weeds of what's in the data pilot um

just to kind of understand that because it seems that this is such a fundamental piece of what drives quality in education and and we're working on a pilot

[01:06:19] that's going to help us better sort of track our progress i'm just understanding historically and how we make sense of of that sure i can start and if folks want yeah folks want to fill in the holes um so for just a little bit of context about how we collect data around the the standards of quality now um so as you know there's there are a lot of standards that are incorporated into the standards of quality um and so how we've approached it thus far has been kind of a dichotomous understanding of compliant versus non-compliant um as you itemize the different standards um so you don't reflect on compliance versus non-compliance for the whole picture but divisions are asked to look at each of

[01:06:59] the individual pieces and indicate to us whether they're compliant or non-compliant and if they're non-compliant they have an opportunity to give us information on their correct action plan some of the the limitations in our in our ability to have been able to dig into that work have been a issue of capacity because there's so much there and then as you think about implementation across school divisions it's going to look a little bit different um and how folks are reaching compliance in some of these standards um and so evidence for for verification might look a little bit differently um so again i think capacity has been a core challenge of us being able to dig in a

[01:07:33] little bit more but with the soq pilot um this has been an opportunity for us to get a better understanding of what compliance means to divisions um so asking them some additional questions on standards that we know to be a priority and of central importance to us um and as we were thinking about the pilot the board's comprehensive plan and and what you all have indicated as priorities were were central to us and thinking about which ones do we really kind of want to drill in on but we will also have an opportunity to collect those evidence pieces from the division for example one of the things that i know we'll be asking of divisions is it's not just to indicate us whether you have a comprehensive plan that does a b c d and e but to provide us your

[01:08:12] comprehensive plan and us to do a little bit of rubric work almost um to make sure that they are they're going into depth and providing the detail that we we really expect to see in something like a comprehensive plan and that's just exemplary of some of the things that we're thinking about um so we'll have a little bit a more complete picture of compliance as well um as as just kind of verifying that compliance is indeed the case on some of these standards that again we knew to to be critical yeah i'll just add a little bit to that i would say the biggest challenge from the 2018 2019 soq review was our data limitations um we didn't have um exit survey data we didn't have

[01:08:51] teacher effectiveness data have race and ethnicity um vacancy data was pretty limited we had dr jen harina had to run proxies for us in a lot of these scenarios um so that we could get some sense of what that might look like because we knew the research told us but our data didn't necessarily easily fit into the methodology that we were using but over the last couple of years it has improved that was actually one of the board's recommendations was to improve some of our data collections and while it's certainly not perfect i think we're making a lot of progress to be able to

[01:09:30] to use data more effectively in any of the new prescriptions or updates to prescriptions that we might do and the only thing i'll add and some of it is a recitation what they said but you got a lot of information just by kind of boiling that down divisions have historically self-reported whether they were compliant or not what we're doing now based on the jlark study and general assembly action that gave us

two positions i think we're going to start doing verifications of their self-compliance that had never been done before and that's essentially what we're saying there as part of that process being that we only got two positions and verifying every

[01:10:09] SOQ would take a lot more resources they asked us to estimate what it would cost to essentially do this full on so we're going to take those two individuals as part of their year we're going to put them and do an on-site verification of all the SOQs map out how many hours it takes them to do a small division how many hours it takes to do a large division then we'll multiply that by all the divisions and then that will be the number that we'll ask for in terms of resources so we're we're going to be pretty far even with the pilot from being able to actually do what we need to do

[01:10:40] the pilot is actually more of a study of how many more resources we need thank you dr robinson um my question is hardly as incisive as the others more out of curiosity but i also appreciate uh president gecker your your context too that was very helpful the presentation was was great um on the slides in which you show the pricing of the initiatives in 19. yeah and kevin i might be off the powerpoint so we'll get it back for you well i don't think i don't think you'll need to

[01:11:19] you showed two prices and i'm assuming that one price was the estimated price and the second was the actual oh first year and second year so that reflects on a biennium budget and what it would costs hardly incisive just curious well i appreciate the opportunity to clarify because that's that's an important one so um thinking oh it's good we're starting this conversation now because we have to act on all of this by november or so right so perhaps mr president may i suggest

[01:11:57] that we part of what we can do today is give the staff guidance on what we'd like to have them come back to us on between now and november and i would put it into perhaps if this is three categories the first is what do we want to reaffirm from our 2019 prescriptions that were reaffirmed in 2020 and that may be easy we may just want to reaffirm them all the one question i would have on that is personally i would suggest should we think about making any adjustments

[01:12:33] on the three as i count them where the general assembly has taken significant action counselors ell and um the specialized student support so i don't i don't know what the answer on that is but perhaps we should think about should we make any adjustments on those three that they've already acted on so that's one category is or do we want to reaffirm then the second category is in your slide 14 i believe is where you listed the things related to um jlark and actually i

[01:13:10] should probably add to that anything recommendations coming from the jlark reports but also anything coming from general assembly action that we really need to address and i would love to see i think it would be appropriate to ask staff to come up with some language for us around what if anything we should do about uh should we add into this year's soq prescriptions around the uh the school improvement program for instance or any of those other issues

[01:13:46] that came up in jailark and it may not be that we need to act on all of them special ed for example might be something that's so adequately addressed elsewhere federal law etc may or may not be a top priority but you know ask for staff to give us guidance on things that you think we should be considering flowing out of the jlark recommendations and then the final category is what what new do we want to put forward for consideration and you've summarized some possibilities on slide 15. i would say on those two that the two bulleted from the african-american superintendent's advisory council

[01:14:21] i think president gecker mentioned these basically the two bulleted in blue i put forward that we don't have any legal authority to address effectively i mean to the extent you're if equitable distribution means between jurisdictions as opposed to within jurisdictions i think we've gone as far as we can go on that first one in incentivizing equitable distribution but i don't think we have to require and i definitely don't think this is not with what president gecker said that we have any authority to reconfigure school division boundaries in a useful way so

[01:14:55] i would say that we not focus on those two but that there may be other things we do want to focus on in your revisit discussions language so for instance i think standards for facilities something we may want to talk about now it may be realistically that there's not a whole lot we could do between now and 20 in november 19 i mean november of 21 but maybe we want to start something in motion for november of 23 or or what or is there something of a general nature we could

[01:15:26] do in november of 21 but facility standards absolutely a crucial issue that relates to our student ability to learn in an important way and that we didn't address before we basically put it off and so you know should we discuss how to approach that of the others there the other one that would interest me the most would be i don't i know we had some discussion about instructional technology resource teachers but i don't remember it well and you know our our i'd love to hear a

[01:16:04] review from staff of where are we on technology instructors and resource teachers i remember there were a couple of different categories there are we where we want to be or is there anything we want to address there and or what else does anybody here want to but is now the right time for us to suggest things we'd like to have staff help us think through it mr gecker my my two comments are actually kind of spot on with what miss holton was talking about i'd ask mr gecker for an opportunity to make some recommendations for things you might consider um i'll start off

[01:16:41] by agreeing on the standards for facilities i do think next month it's worth hearing a debate of whether that's soa or soq and not to confuse uh keisha we would not recommend that we do it after we've done all this work adding that in now but maybe keep soa going and bring that around kind of a 2.0 uh because there's a case that those standards could be soa not soq uh and and and so that's we can probably debate that in the soq committee next month and then make a decision of on that the highest priority for me on that list is actually special education staff

[01:17:17] ratios that jlark didn't address that really and we we kind of had hoped they would uh they have not changed in decades now uh and i would say that uh you know that that's a topic that's of interest to school divisions and when we had promulgated two years ago we made a promise at that time somewhat softly but we would come back and address that and so i think uh i to mr gecker's his historical piece i said this to him in our in our one-on-one meeting beforehand i don't know that you need to do that by november of night uh 21 as you were saying but i think we need to kick off

[01:17:56] the soq committee study of that uh for you know if this is 2.0 for a 3.0 in soq uh and so uh those would be the top two priorities from us the itrt thing just to help clarify what i think that discussion was two years ago there is a debate around do we need it rts or just coaches because technology is now such a part of what all instruction is it does do they have to be focused on technology or can it be a broader coach type i'm not making a recommendation on

[01:18:28] that but i think that's the debate that's at the heart of that dan it appears to me too that the commission on school modernization could provide some data which will help us in the discussion

standards for facilities uh dr lane made an outstanding presentation with commission's last meeting chock full of data that also painted a picture for the commission i think that was very compelling our next meeting right is or subsequent meeting is intended to focus on what does the

[01:19:06] basic facility look like yes which is in part a way to say i hope that you know for the 2021 standard revision i don't see us putting together anything around facilities at this point there is a general assembly commission going on that dr robertson dr lane and i sit on uh talking about

[01:19:36] building facility needs and i think the issue is more complicated than we're going to accomplish in the next couple months honestly and where it sits is also a question i think you are james but which is not to say i think i ought to go left undone it is something you know for years we've talked about and i think we're probably at the point where we can uh take it on but i don't think it's a couple months i think it's a year kind of project not a couple months kind of project

[01:20:11] you know i will say i'm a little bit concerned that sort of the uh the rush to do something will uh overwhelm you know the what i consider to be the need to do something smart you know there's a lot of push right now to build with the amount of money that is purportedly going to flow in and whether that ends up what gets built how it gets built and uh whether those dollars are being spent the most most you know wise way it may take a back seat to gee we just want something

[01:20:49] familiar shiny for a little while so if i may just i i then let's put down a marker so to speak to say that we think that's an soq addressing facilities is a proper or an soq so addressing facilities either in soq or soa is appropriate and we want staff i think that's going to help us think that through but we recognize that you know that needs to go on the work plan over the next yeah unfortunately there are three months there are very good guidelines for what ought to

[01:21:25] be in a new school out there on the website already and then i would suggest that we put also that i do accept dr lane's suggestion that we uh ask staff to help us think through uh special head ratios and i don't know whether that can or should i think i've heard you say you think that also not realistic to be done by by november i i think it's a i think the board's going to want to study that i think it's a six-month project at least but again put down our marker to start it rather than to try to do it in this round i'm comfortable your way on that

[01:22:00] i think that any communication whether it's student srq or you know you also have to lay down some of these workers to the general assembly about where the board is headed where our focus is and i think we have a couple of different options on how we kind of put that out to the public anybody else i'll just affirm i like ms holton's categorization you know kind of three buckets that we look at so that frame works i think very nicely um but i don't have anything more

[01:22:36] mr gecker to add you know to the conversation that's that we've just just heard so thank you miss halton just so i'm not clear in the areas where the general assembly has done significant work let's just say counselors would it be the thought that we ought to conform the soqs to the end product that's significant work as opposed to continuing to advocate for a standard that might be the higher standard and that's not a loaded question right i would say my suggestion was that

[01:23:12] we have a discussion about that question fair enough rather than i'm not recommending an answer yes i'm not recommending an answer either i mean in some sense it would make sense to conform honestly in areas where we've seen significant work done by the assembly dr wells so just an observation

and it could be part of this ongoing conversation that we had when we set the standard in 19 there was a reason for that and so while the assembly has made significant progress and

[01:23:48] we certainly want to acknowledge that i think it would it may raise the question well why all of a sudden or you know it is this is the need not the need or is the standard nuts you know what i mean we made that recommendation really based upon you know the industry group recommendation and we as a board had been making that recommendation not in the form of soqs but in the form of the recommendation for quite some time right the one to 250 and therefore got incorporated into the soqs

[01:24:21] the only reason i think to change because as you say is the need the need is you know as in my view of the world as a result of the work between uh 18 and 19 uh if we had it all to do over again we might prioritize something slightly differently than other things as we learned what drives outcome and so it may be we say let's relieve the pressure and i'm not suggesting this is the answer but this is the hypothetical to get you there it may say we tell the assembly we want

[01:24:58] to relieve the pressure on additional funding in this area because the you know educational outcome increase will be x and instead put it over to a different area right effectively prioritized through doing this where we believe that the educational outcome will be a larger benefit than it would be by moving marginally from 325 councils to 250 or whatever that gap is to essentially acknowledge in a sense that if we were to prioritize we might have gone a different

[01:25:33] direction first that's the that's the reason i would do it if i were going to do it instead of of just saying everything you know everything is as important as everything else at this point given where they are and frankly given the supply of councils in the Commonwealth it may not be more important today to drive that last piece of the ratio down as it is to look at other pieces of the system and just by way of example unlike the counselor ratio as dr. Wilson pointed out that was based on a national standard there's something concrete we had in

[01:26:08] mind and the need the need but the specialized support positions the reason we recommended four rather than three and i'm not sure it was as um solidly grounded as the um school's counselor ratio really everything we did and was you know evidence-based and clearly irrefutable thank you for reminding me just so you know where we were but it may be that three you know that if our if our recommendation was a little bit on the base uh we knew we needed more

[01:26:50] and some of those were they were grounded in national standards um such as you know the psychologist was like one to five hundred or maybe one to seven i can't remember which one but instead of prescribing individual standards for each category we decided to report to a thousand to allow flexibility for the school and the school division to figure out where their priorities need to support the students that would be that might be the one that i would be most likely to say you know what maybe we got close enough on um the ell when i wouldn't i would my personal suggestion

[01:27:26] would be we don't even have a conversation about it without dr durand here since he's our expert i'll just make one uh comment i would be a little wary about changing what you believe the need is if it really is a discussion of priority i think we can do that in the letter that we send them and say hey since you've done three instead of four since you've done 325 so you know 250 we recommend that you focus on other areas moving forward yeah i'm inclined to concur with that perspective i

[01:28:04] mean ideally it's good for schools to have sufficient resources so that people are not overwhelmed and serving students and you hear these numbers especially coming out of covet and you think yeah do we have enough because you know so anyhow i appreciate that uh and on the el i know he's not here so we're not going to discuss it at length but the methodology the money's there

[01:28:38] but the methodology isn't necessarily you had a very uh intentionally tiered focus i don't think we walk away from that methodology so that even if it's eight years down the road understanding that the funding need is different based on your el level is super important okay anybody else thank you dr sale thank you thank you deputy superintendent and of course emily for all your work here i guess we are adjourned and the next committee at uh 25 or at least 2 30 we can do

[01:40:52] for today. I'm going to thank you for joining us today for the first time in person for our special committee to review the standards of accreditation. We're delighted to be here together and we welcome those who are watching via YouTube. During today's committee meeting, we will receive a presentation from Ms. Shelley Loving-Rider on growth assessments required by legislation from the 2021 General Assembly. This legislation calls for the administration of a fall and spring assessment in grades three through eight in reading and mathematics to measure growth and as expected this could have an impact on accreditation so it's timely

[01:41:31] for the committee to receive the following presentation or excuse me receive this presentation following this loving writer's presentation we will engage in a discussion on the recommendations received to date by the committee it will be important for us to prioritize these recommendations and give staff direction on language change needed, which we anticipate reviewing in July or August meeting.

[01:41:54] I will note that the staff has helped me color code using a little of my nerdiness and my engineering type A mindset to color code these recommendations based on feasibility to try to help facilitate the discussion. Before we move into the presentation and discussion, have committee members had a chance to review the minutes from our April 20th, 2021 committee meeting?

[01:42:18] Can I get a motion to approve or amend the minutes? I was not here for that meeting and so I'm a little hesitant to amend the question. Okay. Do I need to have a second? I'll second it just in case.

[01:42:35] Okay, second. Thank you. Ms. Holton? We'll do a roll call vote for the committee members who are here. Dr. Davis-Faught. Aye. Dr. Wilson? Abstain. Okay. And the chair votes aye. Before we start today's meeting or proceed with today's meeting, I do want to provide an opportunity for any public comment or remarks relative to this committee's work do we have any of those interested in our massive audience all right none taken so we will proceed uh so for the

[01:43:10] overview of the growth assessments required by the 2021 legislative action i'm going to now turn it over to mrs shelley loving writer assistant superintendent for assessment accountability and ESEA programs to walk us through this presentation on growth assessment. Good afternoon, everyone.

[01:43:28] It's great to be with you in person and not to see the little squares around your faces. I am going to talk with you a bit this afternoon about some new growth assessments we are putting in place. If you all will let me know if I get off the slides because I can't really see them and I may forget to advance them.

[01:43:46] That would be very helpful. All right, so to begin, we do have legislative action in the 2021 General Assembly, as Dr. Pexton noted, that requires the implementation of through-year growth assessments.

[01:44:03] And the real purpose of these assessments is to allow for a within-year measure of growth that we can use both to inform instructional decisions for students, but also to be used as a measure of growth in accountability so the legislation is phased in in 2021 2022 this coming year it calls for two assessments in reading and mathematics for grades three through eight one new fall assessment so a fall growth assessment and then we will have the regular

[01:44:42] regularly occurring sol test in the spring and we will have the potential of measuring growth from those two assessments. The legislation will be fully implemented in 2022-2023 and we will have three assessments. One in the fall, one in the winter, and again our usual spring assessment.

[01:45:07] So a phase in with fall and spring this year, full implementation in the following year, adding a winter assessment. I know some of you like to actually see the code language, so I did include it for you. The text in red is the additional language that was added by this legislation. So let's talk a little bit more in detail about what we will do in 2021-2022.

[01:45:43] It is already the 16th of June and fall will be upon us very quickly. So we are working very diligently to ensure that we have something in place for this fall. So we want to make sure that these new uh growth through year assessments are aligned to our standards of learning so we are creating shortened computer adaptive tests that will be based on standards of learning test items and those will be used this fall these assessments will be administered to students

[01:46:18] in late august or early september we actually are opening the testing window on the 23rd of august so students will be able to take the test beginning at that date for this fall the assessments will be based on the students previous grade level content so a student in the fourth grade in fall of 2021 will take an assessment based on grade three content one of the reasons we're doing this is we know there's a great deal of concern about unfinished learning from 2020 to

[01:46:57] 2021 so the thought is that this will give us a good measure of potentially unfinished learning and will also give us an excellent baseline for uh the 2021-22 school year um and then as i said before in spring of 22 we'll have the normally occurring sol assessments that will be based on the the current grade level content so the grade four student would of course have grade four content

[01:47:29] okay did i get off this is the timeline okay so again um this is the code language just for your reference basically this says that we do have flexibility in 2021-22 to just do the fall and spring assessments and noting that we will add a winter assessment the following year it also notes the desire to have off grade level items as soon as we are able that is not something we will be able to implement in this coming year so of course this also has an impact on how we measure growth

[01:48:08] as you all know we currently measure growth from spring to spring so if we're looking again at our fourth grader we will be looking back to see how that student performed on the third grade content the previous year and measure growth based on that movement the new legislation does require that the measurement of growth on these new individual student growth assessments be incorporated into accreditation so one of the things we'll be bringing you tomorrow is a request for you all to

[01:48:42] allow the within measure within year measure of growth as well as the spring to spring again currently we do look at that spring to spring we now will be looking at a within year growth measure as well so just as a reminder we do use growth very heavily in the soa it's used in the academic achievement indicators both in the overall achievement and also in gap

[01:49:18] or mathematics and english and the next slide gives us an example of what that looks like too too far too far there we go thank you hasn't caught up yet okay let's see there we go there we go okay i got it maybe i should just turn so i can see it a little better okay so this is a graphic

[01:49:53] you all have seen many times this is jen pava runner's explanation of growth just as a reminder growth and accreditation counts the same as as a passing score so if we have a student who continues to fail the test but shows growth that counts just as just the same as a student passing so i think this is an aspect of the new accreditation system that school divisions really have appreciated so if we look at growth after 2021 2022 so when we look at growth for this year

[01:50:33] we will be comparing the spring sol scores so the spring 22 sol scores to both the spring 21 sol scores from the previous year if the student had a score but we'll also be comparing to that student's score in the fall 2021 and then for this year only we will pick whichever shows the

[01:51:03] greater growth so it really is a pick best scenario where if a student has a spring grade 3 spring 21 and grade 3 score that could be compared to the spring 22 grade 4 score we also would compare that student's spring 22 score to the fall 21 and whichever score shows the greatest growth that is the one that we will use for accreditation so dr wilson um so just to make sure i understand

[01:51:43] the the best ball scenario right um is only for 21 22 and so after 21 22 will we choose or will we say for certain it is a comparison between spring to spring or a comparison fall district so so or is it either or sorry i'm a bit confused so we haven't worked out the details of what we'll do for the following year because remember in 22 23 we have the addition of the winter assessment so

[01:52:19] then we'll be measuring growth from fall to winter to spring yeah so we're we're asking you only for next year you will decide what you want to do in subsequent years but we don't want you to make that decision at this time and so just to clarify we'll come back to you with another recommendation so what we're asking you to act on is just for this year and to pick best thank you i do have a question on that because maybe my wheels are slowing down because it's cold but i'm processing

[01:52:53] a little slower so i understand the either or i guess i'm trying to understand the logic or value between and i also understand why maybe considering um from the spring third grade year know capturing any gap or any lost opportunity for learning but when it comes to that post comparison why not only do fall 21 to spring why why the or

[01:53:29] why still considering the other I think there are a couple of reasons we are recommending the either or and pick best there may be some students who don't have a spring 21 score so then they would have the the fall 21 as a backup um we were also seeing it as a benefit for school division so if we do have a situation where a student had greater growth between spring 21 and spring 22 we would provide that credit that might be a situation where a

[01:54:09] school division had a very strong summer program and so if we were to look at the fall 21 to spring 22 comparison the school division really wouldn't get the credit for that work they did over the summer so it really is a it is a situation we're asking you to approve that really is specific to this year because it is so unusual dr lane i don't know if you wanted to add anything no i thought the two justifications that you mentioned for why we

[01:54:44] were considering fall and why we were considering spring were really good uh i also i should i don't want to speak for the the president because he's left he and i have debated this issue at length and i

know one of his takes that you should know is um if a student uh meets growth from fall to spring but their results are worse than the spring previous do we give credit for that and so there's i just want to i want to interject that because i think he'll bring that up so that's just something

[01:55:19] to think about that he has been debating is we would count the fall to spring as long as the result wasn't worse than the previous spank spring so you know other than that i i feel pretty confident with the method i i would not get into that because i do think that there are enough students that are not going to have scores in the spring that you know you're basically you're you're basically giving a benefit to having not taken it if if you if you treat it that way

[01:55:49] everyone okay if i go on yes okay i'm sorry this is so the fall score is for the previous grade which just makes sense because they're coming into a new grade in the fall so you're going to go in content from the grade they just left and so in some measure you are going to have in the fall a measure of maybe what the year-end would have been whether or not they've gone to summer school or participated in summer learning because it's it's based on the prior grade it's not based on a baseline of what the new

[01:56:28] grade represents so in some ways I wouldn't say it's totally apples to apples but Shelly and I had this conversation it is measuring from the same standard right now so essentially the end of third grade standard in May the end of third grade standard in September and then and then the length of the year and that's that's one of the benefits about the pick best scenario that we liked as it is measuring from the from essentially the same standard now keep in mind the fall diagnostic assessments not an SOL right fall test is not an SOL and that's nomenclature we hope that you'll carry with us because We don't want it to be confused with the S-Well test.

[01:57:08] The fall diagnostic assessment growth assessment is much shorter. And so the spring assessment is the traditional assessment. So we did talk to our psychometricians at Pearson, even with the shorter assessment, could we stand behind the validity of the growth?

[01:57:23] And they said yes. - Yeah, that's for me what I would wonder about. I mean, I can see the either or given, I know they're not exactly identical to the same test, but ultimately I would hope there's an effort to ensure that the content represents enough of what you'd hope a student would retain that gives some validity to looking at fall 21 to spring 22 as a measure of growth.

[01:57:54] - And certainly we wanted to assess students on what they've learned, not on what they have not learned. - Thank you. - Ms. Holden. - Followed up on that topic of you all being very creative a difficult circumstance i appreciate that i thought tell you i understood that where we are now the computer adaptive tests that even starting out that test in the fall of 21 might you might start them out based on the content from the prior year but if they're doing well then you're going you know if you start them out testing them on the third grade content and they're doing well then you're going to be asking them fourth grade content questions or if you start them out on

[01:58:32] fourth grade content and they're doing poorly then you would drop back to third or go up to fifth you are correct that is one of the benefits of computer adaptive testing it just wasn't something we could pull off by this fall so that is the plan the state state this year being an odd year but the steady state the fall test really it's not like the fall test we wouldn't want for a steady state to have the fall test comparing the fall to spring growth but the fall based on completely different content from the spring doesn't really make sense so if it's all on a

[01:59:09] spectrum and computer-adaptive capacity to move between levels based on where the student is, then we're okay in the steady state act of this transition year. I think it's best to think of this year really as an unusual year where we're making some recommendations that are specific to the fact that this is an atypical year.

[01:59:32] And also, just to be honest, you know, there are only so many changes we could implement given the short timeframe. um a testing program is a lot like an aircraft carrier it's not easy to turn it so yeah and with that in mind i know shelly went into this a little bit but understanding that three years from now we will have computer adaptive assessments that will go off grade level up and down we're going to add items beyond below third grade beyond eighth grade so you'll have more stretch and less

[02:00:07] ceiling and flooring effects uh and and all of that which is more similar to some of the vendor based assessments that that uh school divisions are giving and that's why we're not ready to make recommendations on the out years in terms of the methodology because we we want to we want to make those recommendations to you as those assessments are built and the legislation does give us three years to phase in each component uh this year is just having the fall the second year when we add the winter we will go off grade level the third year is when we'll build the stretch items and so it's going to take us a good three years to get to all that and then of course the vertical scale

[02:00:43] launching will also be a huge help because we'll be able to show where students are on a broader continuum than just a 600 scale for grade level i have a question shelley and this is playing devil's advocate is is there a way that a a teacher could incent is there a way that a teacher could not place emphasis on a fall growth assessment in order to make it look better in the spring is is do you understand what i'm asking okay is is that a possibility with this program and i think

[02:01:23] that is a concern that people often share about fall assessments i mean i think we would would hope that teachers would understand the diagnostic value of the test now and to be fair it's not a very long test so we'll get some information but it won't be won't give specific information about where the student needs assistance but you know that is a concern um we have i think a strong relationship with school divisions and i think we will certainly work to train to make sure that teachers understand that that's really not the best situation for their students

[02:02:03] and we're still working on what the security protocols will look like in the fall and uh you know everyone has to sign off on the security protocols in order to deliver our assessment you're well aware of that um you know we very well may need to think about language that uh addresses what happens if you tell students to fail the test on purpose i mean it may actually have. That's an ethical issue in my mind. I agree. Okay, so let's talk a little bit about methodology. So one of the benefits of assessing the previous grade levels content

[02:02:43] in the fall is that we can use our current methodology, which of course is looking at previous grade level score to current grade level score. And so we will be able to use that same methodology to measure growth this year as dr lane mentioned we will be reporting on the vertical scale for growth and there is an example of the vertical scale just as a reminder for you all this is the scale that goes across the tests so you're familiar with

[02:03:19] the 0 to 600 scale for each test this is the 2000 to 8000 scale that goes across the tests so we will be able to report growth on this vertical scale but we'll be able to use that old methodology that we've used

for a while looking at previous year content to current year content just applying it to the vertical scale and then as we've talked about before we'll

[02:03:52] come back to you for 22 23 to talk with you about how we'll measure growth once we are looking at the three assessments and looking at just within your growth so what we'll be coming to you tomorrow is asking you to approve, oops, I did not mean to do that. Okay, we'll be coming to you tomorrow to ask you to approve the use of current year growth, so within year growth, as well as the

[02:04:29] year-to-year growth as a measure of a growth for accreditation. And then to allow us to use the Pick Best methodology. And then, as I said before, we'll come back to you subsequently with recommendations about how we measure growth moving forward.

[02:04:46] Dr. Pexton, I thank you for your time. If there are any other questions, I'd be happy to answer them. Any additional questions, Dr. Wilson? To what extent are divisions clear, aware, understand-- I'm sorry, I don't recall what we have shared to date about our work in Portland legislation and our desire,

[02:05:16] So, so far we have had two superintendents' email communications with divisions, telling them about the legislation, explaining to them what the assessments would look like in terms of shorter computer-adaptive tests based on the previous grade levels content.

[02:05:41] We had an email that went out last week that provided a little more detail, let them know that the window would open on the 23rd of August and giving them more detail about the length of the assessment that was one of the questions we had gotten so for reading the number of items varies from 17 to 19 so it is a very short assessment and for math it's 20 to 25 so it is very short that was something that school divisions had really wanted to know you know how long is it going to to be and then beginning this next week we'll begin to have webinars with the

[02:06:17] division director of directors of testing finally known as the DDOTs to talk to talk more about how we we implement this moving forward so there have been a few communications we've tried to keep school divisions up to date you know in terms of what is happening so if I'm trying to wrap my

[02:06:48] head around. I know future state is still under discussion, but if there's some intention to, whether it's, you know, the fall, winter, spring, all be based on the same grade level content, then when you start to look at the continuum of it, are we not then at some point missing the opportunity to get that even a similar look now? Now, I know this is new, but because this

[02:07:27] first initial one is looking at previous years through the end of the fourth that that next year that's a specific data set it's not saying how much growth you've made relative to the grade you're in at that point necessarily um see what i'm saying it's not fourth grade fourth grade and then we move on and then it's fifth grade to fifth grade sixth grade six so are we missing any is there any risks anything we're missing in in making this type of transition knowing we're limited knowing the unique conditions of covid and that you know so we know there were learning gaps

[02:08:03] and that so i just i'm just trying to think if there's any risks we're looking at as far as when we really try to look at the continuum and the advocate and i think again because this past year was atypical yeah you know looking at something from the previous grade level does help us identify that unfinished learning and it also allows us to use that old methodology of looking at previous grade level to current grade level. Now, in the out years, beginning in 22-23, the test

[02:08:38] will be based on that grade level's content, but as Dr. Lane noted, we will begin to adjust the algorithm to allow it to pull off grade level content if necessary. So, again, we'll take our fourth grader, and that student in the fall might be really struggling with particular concepts in math. So the algorithm might drop down and pick up some third grade items. So I think we will get to the place where we're focusing more on the current grade

[02:09:14] level content so that you are getting that measure from fall to spring with the ability to reach up and reach down and perhaps up as appropriate for the student. okay that helps other questions okay well thank you miss lovingrider for your presentation we really appreciate it thank you i know this is very complex so thank you all for your patience absolutely appreciate you okay um so we will continue um now to have our discussion and

[02:09:52] prioritization on the recommendations received by the committee by the committee um as i noted in my open comments staff helped me to color code each of these recommendations based on feasibility so in green uh you will see recommendations that would be relatively easy changes or additions to regulatory languages highlighted in yellow are the recommendations that need additional information or staff or a staff recommendation and those in red are items that need additional data time stakeholder engagement before staff recommendation or language can be made um generally speaking most

[02:10:28] of the items highlighted in red would not be part of any changes to the soa during this comprehensive revision process um so with that before i open the floor up just to uh have a discussion and see kind of where the committee and and board members are relative to the recommendations i did ask emily and and some of the staff members to take some time with the yellow in the red items and just give us at a very high level some context of the why like is it a is it a data thing is it a time thing just so that might add some

[02:11:05] more to our discussion thanks dr. Paxton I'm gonna walk through kind of the reasoning behind we color-coded these the way that we did and I have dr. Lane and Holly and Michael here to kind of help me you know phone a friend if I need to do that so I'm not going to go through too many of the green ones especially on the technical edits on that side I'll say you know for the for the technical edits we actually already have language ready to go should the the special committee want to move forward with that so I'll just mainly go

[02:11:43] through those that are red and yellow and just give you a little bit more context to why we thought we should color code them in that manner so first up just kind of providing the summary of panel discussion recommendations a lot of folks indicated in those panel discussions that they liked the idea of a new school climate indicator rather than chronic absenteeism they also noted that chronic absenteeism has changed including that as an indicator has changed some of their policies and practices but really our data is fairly limited

[02:12:18] in this area as it relates to school climate indicator beyond chronic absenteeism right now we do have the school climate and working conditions survey that has been administered but it's not administered in every grade level most recently it was administered in grades four and five and in grades nine through twelve and then the working conditions was also administered to all those that have a virginia teaching light or some kind of license from the state so beyond you know kind of what we have right now in chronic absenteeism we don't have a lot of data as it

[02:12:55] relates to school climate to consider a new indicator in this area so that was the reasoning behind why we indicated it red as we continue to get additional data collections that could change but i think in in the reality of where we are with this comprehensive review we're just not quite ready yet um because we do need that additional data time and stakeholder engagement on this one um next up i have that many of our panel speakers um praise the use use of growth in the accreditation model but also encouraged us to consider how growth can be measured beyond

[02:13:35] standardized testing. I'll note that this item should probably be orange rather than red or yellow. With Shelley's presentation that we just heard on the addition of new through-year growth assessments, adding any additional measures would be a particularly heavy lift. So I think this one, like I said, maybe should be coded orange rather than yellow or red because we do have some additional indicator growth that's going to be factored in this coming year all of the panelists encourage additional flexibility with

[02:14:12] graduation requirements and verified credits we have certainly provided a lot of flexibility with kovid and I think that we could look at that a little bit closer but don't have a specific staff recommendation at this time but if that is something that the committee would like to explore and to press a put together a staff recommendation we could certainly do that I'll note that we have provided a fairly extensive amount of flexibility on the verified credit side over the last couple of years and especially obviously in these last two

[02:14:45] years with coping and then certainly if any of my things to add feel free to do that the last one kind of under this header emphasize the need for equity in the accreditation system we have kind of further down in here where we do plan to add some equity considerations into the SOA compliance side and so I think that that we are doing that but certainly that needs to be a continued focus for us through other comprehensive reviews to the SOA and I will skip all the technical edits and kind of move down to the recommendation from the

[02:15:25] African recommendations from the African American Superintendents Advisory Council. You know, they provided a lot of great recommendations to this committee and to the full board to consider on a variety of topics. The first one being to include a discipline disproportionality as an indicator in the state's accountability system. And you all received a presentation from Dr. Piperena and some of our colleagues in student services around this topic.

[02:15:56] um and i think that there there is a lot of interest um in adding this kind of indicator but as you'll remember from that presentation we are getting ready to start a new data collection um on student discipline and so i think we need some time to collect that data for a couple of years one option could be if the committee is interested in it we could start reporting that data on the school quality profile for a couple of years and then in the next comprehensive review consider that data to be potentially an indicator in accountability um and i would say the same and

[02:16:34] i might um phone a friend on a couple of these uh to create an opportunity in access indicator which would require schools and divisions to report enrollment in advanced coursework and details on course offerings um i think we again just need a little bit more time on this one um in order to to think through some of the the feasibility behind it um an opportunity and access indicator you know when we've been thinking about adding any indicators we've had those principles in mind that we need to have valid and reliable data um and i think while we can get there

[02:17:13] we're just not quite ready for that um thus far um and kind of same a lot of these kind of go together sure absolutely there was a question on the annual report perhaps that asked about enrollment in advanced level there's probably I believe I I

[02:17:53] seem to recall we had a gifted ed presentation right so i don't know i think there's a i think it's probably in the master schedule collection so we would have to disaggregate it i don't know that there's a special report on that correct yeah one of the challenges currently is we're currently in the process of building the master schedule collection data collection process

[02:18:27] especially with the schedule codes and moving to national codes so that we can have better transparency on what kids the content the kids are taking and one of the real challenges is that for years school divisions were using locally decided codes so it was just a local code for it was a catch-all and so we've asked them to move to very specific codes now so there's a transition process to make sure that our data is really clean uh and it'll take them well for next school year

[02:19:02] they've been told to use those and we've deactivated some of the codes but there will be some transition time to make sure that the codes that they are using are appropriate and accurate so um so i appreciate that mr. rollin my observation was that and i certainly understand that not having the data or a structure even yet to collect the data is something that is aspirational but i guess if and i'm unlikely wrong but if there's already a mechanism in place that gets toward the intent

[02:19:40] that uh asap is in here perhaps as a way to to begin understanding uh access and opportunity for students of color in courses that are at whatever whatever the level is but i'm just suggesting that adding an indicator may not be possible but is there a way to get to surfacing information that would be useful to informing into the local divisions processes and whatnot and i think a lot of these recommendations that we have highlighted yellow or red um you know if

[02:20:20] they i think we've highlighted them in this manner because we're not ready for them to be an indicator into accreditation but i think that this committee could certainly recommend items to start being included on the school quality profile so that that information is starting to be uncovered in the public um and that traditionally has kind of been um a little bit of a ground zero to where some of these data points behind indicators start is on what used to be the school report cards now the the school quality profile um you know and so by no means is the color coding meant to say we're putting it on a shelf and never touching it it's just to say that we're not ready for it to be

[02:21:00] an indicator in accreditation right now and i think a lot of what michael just told us about master schedule collection speaks to a number of the recommendations from asac again very worthy recommendations and ones that that we are working towards and need to consider but just not quite ready yet for that prime time to be for schools to be held accountable through accreditation two here that i have highlighted in green to require an equity advisory committee at the division level and to require school boards to adopt equity plans

[02:21:38] or the establishment of some kind of equity goals both of those could be added into your soa compliance area it would be a relatively easy change to our soa language and then kind of the last header i have here are just topics and questions um that need additional information or need a staff recommendation i will note um that we did i didn't color code a lot of those because i wanted those to be topics for discussion um for for the committee um but we did go ahead and color

[02:22:12] code um the considering the consolidation of diploma options um obviously received a significant amount of public comment on this topic. It was a thought exercise for the committee to consider.

[02:22:29] We do know that there needs to be a lot more stakeholder engagement before we are to even in this area and so I did go ahead and currently would love to get the the committee's feedback on on all of these bullets here to give us some additional direction on kind of where you'd like to go because ideally we can start bringing some language to you all in July or in August to bring recommendations to the full board this fall and so dr pexton i'll turn it over to you

[02:23:04] unless anyone else has things to add and we're also here to to answer questions as you all continue your discussion i might just add on timely's last piece i think the department has no interest in this time as a single diploma option we would not recommend it before it on that okay so thank you for that additional context uh emily for all the recommendations uh so what i was going to recommend

[02:23:38] just to to move uh move the discussion forward was really looking at the green recommendations first the look it's kind of the low-lying fruit the things we can kind of address and move on from uh there are 54 technical edits uh that are listed there uh so i'll start with just the technical edits only um and absent from the other green recommendations is there any discussion additional questions clarification or concern that that the committee has or any board members

[02:24:12] with accepting those as as they are or does the would the committee and or board uh require more time considering you did just get these recommendations i mean you had all weekend but

[02:24:36] committee member but thank you for the opportunity to engage. First of all thank you for the color code. It was very helpful. One green item that I just wanted to ask about, which was having a hard time finding out, was something about clarifying the requirements for the work-based learning alternatives and civic engagement I think it was.

[02:25:21] that's not the one but there was one that was going to clarify what counts towards the workplace learning options and that was I just wanted more clarification we're not too careful if we're not careful that thing gets watered down to the point of being non-existent I changed the bullets to numbers so I know which number it is it's about the 11th bullet down in I believe update

[02:25:56] language related to citizenship skills to reflect a variety of work-based learning experiences? Yes, that's the one. Thank you. Update language, yes. So yes, I just would love to hear more about what you have in mind on that with the concern that we don't want to water it down beyond our intent.

[02:26:27] We don't actually have the, you haven't given us that technical language. we did walk through that in the march 17 so you actually and i think it's just your four votes we do have actually you can probably pull it up yeah i can go back to the march i'll go back to mark 17 and look and see if i have any wording concerns i'll i'll share it back with you here going okay um that being said again relative to the technical edits if you want to respect the time the committee to review these

[02:27:05] if there's any reservation the exception of the one that ms fulton pulled that down to any reservations of the others um accepting as is and or taking some more time to make that decision dr pexton i have one clarification for the team if i can ask about it um there is one that makes a

[02:27:37] technical edit to amend boy scouts girl scouts to just scouts uh there's actually my understanding is that boy scouts are trying to change their name to scouts because they just allow girls and that may the phrase scouts may not include girl scouts in the legal sense that's probably worth looking at i don't i think that's actually in court so you might want to just leave them

[02:28:07] separate and then are we defining work based learning experiences somewhere else maybe you

[02:28:43] all got some uh guidelines that you're working on that are in process so the soa would refer to workplace learning more broadly and then that term is uh spelled out in further with further clarity yeah yeah yeah okay i'm a member of the conference i'm comfortable saying that internships and externships become a subset

[02:29:16] oh that's the 11th bullet you were just clarifying that it's about internships uh and so no i know but i um why why does the title reference citizenship skills

[02:29:47] and and miss holton's question yeah i would just i would just more accurately reflect for the public that this i don't think it really is about citizenship skills i think it's about internships

[02:30:19] right yeah so i would just say that so just one observation so as we think about our comfort with the recommendations that are here i am comfortable i'm a red line kind of professional and i kind of need to see all of the language rather than bouncing back and forth so certainly with the recommendations that are all in green seeing what that actually looks like compared to what's currently in the document is very helpful to me so on its surface i don't have any things

[02:30:59] that are you know being flat that i'm flagging at this moment but certainly once i see it all there may be something that doesn't quite fit for me so that's the only i mean i appreciate this whole observation about teaching and work-based learning and all of that we don't want to water down the work thing so to that point um would it would it be uh appropriate then to consider asking

[02:31:36] for that information that you can file the religion could do that and then we can use this time okay so that they could use the time between now, maybe the next thing to walk over more comfortable with that information.

[02:31:54] And this is specifically related to the information. Yeah, and we have a technical edit redline ready. We can also, you know, once we get some additional 30 of some of the other edits, we can try to incorporate those into kind of a full document that are moving.

[02:32:12] So that's kind of how we'll frame the rest of this conversation is really making sure we're clear what we'd like to see in a final document for our review based on recommendations that we wouldn't even want to consider.

[02:32:31] I'm remembering another question within the green, under the recommendations from the African-American Superintendents Advisory Council, there is both a green flag requiring equity advisory committee at the division level and a required school board for adoption equity plans, including the establishment of equity goals.

[02:32:53] Are those considered alternatives? I mean, I guess we could do either or both, but maybe that's worthy of some discussion about a panel of whether you want to do both. Maybe the committee serves a slightly different purpose from having a plan on the board.

[02:33:13] And I think to Ms. Holton's observation, I think depending on the locality, they may see an advisory committee versus a set of goals, the equity plan, you know, and one heeding the other or not.

[02:33:34] So I do think asking that question is an either or or both and is an observation. And personally, I would like to plan with the goals is the most important one. So I might do that through and over, you know, and yeah, maybe, and that's what I do, maybe it's also useful.

[02:33:54] Right. Yes. You know, yeah, I just think it's so specific to locality. So would we be interested in some language being proposed relative to those two bullets for us to consider how that might look?

[02:34:19] also um i know that this is this recommendation has come and i'm not answering your question i acknowledge that i know this recommendation is coming from the asac but of course this applies i wonder if we've had any input from uh other from all divisions or as many of the dr lane with your advisory committee um sorry slack we don't call it slack anymore but leadership

[02:34:53] Council yeah and whether or not any of these recommendations particularly that effect that would go to things like setting up the advisory committees and whatnot if that's been vetted at all or and or what is the plan for getting input from the public general I think that's the broader question is how do we want to get feedback we have certainly uh SSLC still meets but we have gone to more of a whole state solution during covid and been talking with almost every superintendent on a regular basis uh and we have certainly at numerous times

[02:35:31] throughout that process made them aware of this soa work and to provide feedback but uh i think unless we directly engage that you know they're not thinking at this level of granularity so we'll uh we'll take your advice on that but certainly emily and i can come up with a plan for engagement on that i think once we get to final draft status i think we can use those couple months to really dig in to just just the point of note not that it's sufficient feedback but that was the other green recommendation from the panel we had that they all

[02:36:08] emphasize the need to focus on equity that doesn't give us any specifics on how or what specifically to go do right that's just a notional nod so what I what I think I heard there is that we can plan or expect to maybe get some additional feedback on how you might be some stakeholder engagement yeah and with the not just superintendents but I think the SBA we're we're going to their

[02:36:46] executive committee in July I think so we can that we can do some of that work

[02:36:51] then well you're doing vaco on the day we can talk about other indicators we might want to put into

[02:43:33] that that's the tool that would be the basis for whatever what's the timeline we were required to could consolidate those under legislation, by the way, which is why I believe there's-- even the General Assembly would not want there to be another survey. So now we don't have any.

[02:43:52] Right. So yeah, that's what I'm saying. I think our next step is to take that survey and decide how we might measure it to a rating, if that's your goal.

[02:44:22] You completely agree with Pam that we don't change federal indicator. We do anything I agree that it should be additional with the chronic action fee as an agent. So what's the timeline of where either the development implementation data gathering of that survey well I in the context of what Ms. Holden said around not doing anything big right now right I would finish up what we're doing and then I would

almost immediately go into I think you get about two or three months of what's actually in that survey how could

[02:44:59] you consolidate it into a single rating bring in some superintendents to talk about that so I think that's something we could start pretty quickly after we wrap up what I'm going to call 1.0 because I do think that I really be making some notes when we

[02:45:34] recap and be honest all right any other discussion on that potential recommendation basically sounds you know what what I've what I've gathered is that we're going to take advantage of the tool that we have available for us today we'll put a plan in place to how can we use that information tool use it the information in front of the right stakeholders get some get some feedback and see what that data is telling us what that feedback is telling us about what a potential indicator

[02:46:05] could be relative to school climate all right so that we had three other uh red-coded uh recommendations under the advisory council's section i counted them as three could be like three and a half first one you know dealing with the discipline disproportionality and it was noted that we did receive a presentation earlier from dr. five arena and we're getting deal is getting ready to start the data

[02:46:42] data collection process and that that data could be indicated during our next comprehensive review there's an agreement with that and we would leave that recommendation as is and not see any need to take any action now during this review concurrence on that and then the second bullet part of so Emily I guess that two sub bullets under create an opportunity and access indicator one was yellow one was red I don't know if we talked about this include a measure

[02:47:21] of access to academic rigor and accreditation which could be a composite indicator did I miss that one I didn't make any notes on that one as to the why the context I think that when we were talking about in context to the master schedule collection that was that okay I put there were several in relation to the master schedule collection why we aren't quite ready for that yet gotcha I had that there to do the wrong one okay so any concern or feedback with the reality of that recommendation the including a measure of access to the

[02:48:01] rigor again I'm just looking for low-lying fruit disc well again I would agree I think this one would be a valuable one potentially for the next round and maybe one way to think about it and this kind of gets you into the yellow what do we need to do meanwhile to be able to set ourselves up to potentially add an indicator in a later phase and you know the discipline disproportionality we're already in the process of gaining more data on it but on this opportunity and access indicator if there were maybe maybe whatever in a

[02:48:37] long-winded way trying to say what about let's do the yellow require schools and divisions to report more so that we might have something to build on into an indicator at some point and is that what we're doing already or is that something you need to ask to me I think we're going to begin collecting more information that schedules so i think what you're suggesting is not just schedules but schedules and compare them to demographics right yes so we already collect we're getting ready to collect

[02:49:14] oh we are already so just to make sure i'm clear so we are collecting some form of data we want to start consolidating that report and we'll make sure that it's uh we need uh emily i correct me if i'm wrong we're going to verify whether or not it's in the soa that requires

[02:49:44] collecting it that which might be something that would be a recommendation all right so summarize what i heard relative really to that i'm going to say that full bullet as far as creating an opportunity and access indicator uh relative to the first supported yellow the recommendation is to allow some time for that data to be refined and then eventually consolidate it into a report for the board to be able to review and better understand what opportunities might exist in creating relative to that

[02:50:22] recommendation and then the same thing was it the same thing for the the measures of its success we should consider that at the next review and based on what this report information is telling us it might help inform that discussion is that correct i think that's i think that's fair all right and then the last read uh under the advisory uh council's recommendations was to establish a single indicator or composite score related to the school climate i guess that ties back up to what we additionally said before

[02:50:57] so i think we've addressed that one unless and i i know ms holton brought this up the next two bullets were green did i hear that you want more stakeholder engagement on that so that might be more yellow is that right that we they wanted to see some red line language on that but that we also needed to include stakeholder engagement on this topic i do think our school boards and superintendents will want to weigh in on that at this point i i agree that it's probably more

[02:51:34] yellow than it is green um it's less of a movie right yeah let's let's go get more yeah i'm gonna make that note emily came first to add yellow just to keep us clear um so with that that that leaves just four recommendations um since we're already in the african americans superintendents advisory council section um one of the yellow recommendations we already addressed uh up top about requiring schools to report on student enrollment the other one

[02:52:09] that was yellow was the very last one which also relates to the master schedules um so i'm assuming that that probably connects back then to the to the point we're making about the data collection and refining it and am I missing something there the very last recommend no I think that's right you're correct yes right okay once we get the new master schedule collection we'll be able to talk more about that okay so the last two recommendations that we haven't spoken to specifically is back

[02:52:42] up under the panel discussions so well in some case we have you know recommendation around growth and the accreditation model and the discussion that we just had today and ultimately this this recommendation was about adding additional methods and we pointed out how this would probably be more orange than yellow and so that being said considering what we have on the table today and tomorrow is there any opposition or concern about I guess

[02:53:22] allowing this one to mature we need to have some time to allow this one to mature all right and then the last one I'll encourage additional flexibility with graduation requirements and in late knowledge that the department has been quite flexible as a result of COVID and that they would be willing to provide a staff recommendation if it was of our interest for them to do so thoughts or feedback on that the only one I have and I apologize I'm I've read this so many

[02:54:01] times I don't know that I if I've missed it the technical amendments but I feel like I'm speaking for Francisco here he really wanted to make sure we came out with something solid on the EL piece in terms of SLIFE students now that we have a definition.

[02:54:20] Is there a flexibility in the way that we would count those students in the GCI or? and that's what I'm saying is that I know we haven't really honed in on that but

[02:54:55] that's that's the one yellow piece that i think might be green i think that i heard pretty loud and clear from francisco he wanted to make a decision there that's the happens the new slide and so we should probably discuss that next month with him here but my guess is that he's going to want to recommend something such that someone that falls within that definition you know may not may not count against the school in the dropout rate not so much uh gci i think i think gci kind of

[02:55:32] covers it if i shelly don't you think so i think it's more the dropout rate okay and so did i miss something and how that connects back to the additional flexibility within graduation requirements well i i think that he considers that flexibility in the way that you have calculated in graduation

[02:56:10] dropout rates and I think that as as I sit here and think about I think it's more a dropout rate I'm pretty sure on that because GCI gives you credit for staying enrolled and some other things and I feel pretty good about the flexibility in the GCI other other topics similar to EL students relative to flexibility and graduation requirements that we need to be considering as part of this or we might want to consider as part of this recommendation and or get additional input on Emily referenced her remarks on this you reference you know i wondered if this was specific to the conditions we're operating in

[02:56:48] around cobit versus something that might be more fundamentally tied to structure for graduation requirements um i i couldn't recall i remember that conversation about seat time and hours but then i can remember if it's related to this or not because there was a lot of conversation about well not a lot but there was one panel that i recall spoke very directly around the need to evaluate things with respect to yeah what the panel was talking about is you've provided through

[02:57:22] covid flexibility to to count local performance assessments and other types of assessments in lieu of history writing the non-federally mandated assessments and that's gone really well uh and of course there's budget language which will govern this after covid that you know essentially says that uh the more permanent solution around these assessments have to be uh state-created tasks and rubrics and that's why i think it's yellow more than green because we still need a little bit

[02:57:56] more time on their tasks and rubrics that fair show yeah so but i i think we might do that outside of the soa right in july right so i think that that's why that's why it's shaded the way it is okay so again any other specific topics relative to this recommendation that we want to call out

[02:58:33] okay um so i was gonna wrap up by just addressing that last section of topics questions that need a staff recommendation we've made a note there i've made a note for the second bullet um that we'll really wait till next month to discuss that one a little bit further get some good input from dr dron um we've got three other uh items there uh well actually and one is kind of relative to

[02:59:09] what we were just talking about um any accreditation changes needed due to covet that maybe not not specific to graduation requirements just generally something that miss holton in reviewing kind of notes and everything from the last year or so Ms. Hilton has brought up a couple of times you know just you were questioning is there anything that we would need to change um because of COVID we have SLA not suggesting that there needs to be right yeah yeah what I was thinking is kind of I guess maybe to ask that question differently based on all the you know we've

[02:59:49] been flexible we've done some things but hindsight hindsight now being 2020 a year and some change into this is there anything that that has become maybe more codified in what we're doing that should be considered whether or not it meets the level of breaching the standard of accreditation is what I

would ask the things that jump out to me are really related to virtual and and we're gonna Nora that separately so I I would I would say I don't nothing stands out to me that's

[03:00:24] not already gonna be addressed through other ways or guidance okay and there's one piece in budget language around k3 class size reduction that's been under discussion but I think you know that's not the outside of that all right I'm jumping down now to student discipline and disproportionality aren't ready to be added to the creation model yet but how do they fit into the committee's recommendations and I made a note came up earlier about things that might be

[03:01:02] recommend it to be captured on a school quality profile as possibly being one of them yeah because i think you know even though this is an soa committee still putting recommendations forward for items to be added to the school quality profile so any feedback or input from the committee or board relative to that specific topic i like the recommendation of adding it

[03:01:35] to the school profile. As we think about what our outcome will be, so there's this tension I think between I know I have information that reveals or illustrates where schools and divisions are with regard

[03:02:14] to discipline and disproportionality, we've collected for a long time, right, but what do i do with it so where does information force action right that's the tension that we're coming up against and i think the school quality profile as a beginning point makes good sense i'm worried that it becomes just information with no action force or or no um it's inert but you understand what i mean um that we what we want to see is change so what is the right

[03:02:54] mechanism i think that's worth attention is it a tool to to to say here it is or is it a mechanism to actually move to improvement that's where we can take some time and i've had it on the profile initially before as a first step makes really good sense and then we can give some time to think about what's the next step beyond that yeah as an example i think transparency around it is a lot because i think it's a good first step as well because we do collect this data we do

[03:03:32] record it in an aggregate but we don't really break it down by school which this will be really interesting uh but i think of it like the um remember back in the day everyone thought that 65 percent of expenditures I feel like I've been I've worked 100 years in the last but uh but remember we used to be used to have worry about whether it's 65 percent of the expenditures were instructional and then there was some requirements around that later everyone was already there by the time the requirement came to place I think this is similar to that where it's let's set

[03:04:12] out an expect let's report it first and i think your second phase is set out an expectation that doesn't lead to an accreditation deficit and then once people have moved or not moved then you build accountability around it uh but i i think school communities are going to hold themselves accountable when this starts coming out much more transparently in a quality profile back in the

[03:04:46] so what I've captured is that there seems to be concurrence around the fact there's value in using the school quality profile as a starting point to capture information and but we we agree that that's not it that's not all that possibly this this type of transparency would help to be a resource to inform a

[03:05:16] later accreditation review all right the last one is again relevant to the discussion today I kind of feel like we answered part of that question today do the new through assessments have an impact on growth calculations and accreditation model and what decision points need to be made a special committee and board I think we have one of those decision points tomorrow as a

[03:05:50] a board um my perspective is i i feel like as again as that process matures those decision points are going to be brought to us and um and um and uh we'll have more information about the impact of those growth calculations and so i don't know that there's more that we need right now um

[03:06:15] relative that conversation but you know i'll open it up to you guys if you think otherwise okay well we just went through 65 recommendations so we got something done today see how good we are when we regularly in person you know i'm not even as cold anymore i actually got some work done now um so appreciate appreciate uh the committee and the board members and dr lane and the department's

[03:06:52] uh uh input and and support and really just trying to synthesize everything um that we've learned and all the information we've gathered the people we've heard from into some sort of starting point of the so what like you know what do we do with it so um just to kind of summarize and then we'll wrap up uh from the technical edit standpoint we're going to get a red line review of current state versus what would be proposed we as far as the other uh green recommendations um a couple of

[03:07:28] those greens turned yellow uh where we feel like from the equity standpoint we've got some more opportunity there to get some some more stakeholder input um to help maybe get to give some more fidelity to what those recommendations could look like um and so uh and and that really addresses the remaining portions of all the greens very strong connection there and even to runs over to some of the yellows um for a lot of the red edits there was a lot of consensus

[03:08:01] that more data more time um we did want uh you know i'll say a commitment to a plan as far as next steps relative to the um one second oh the school climate uh survey and and really next steps for that in the short term as far as you getting some good feedback from from the tool that's out there now seeing what it's telling us

[03:08:40] that's really going to help inform a lot of the other red line or red colored recommendations that we had um and then the last thing that i noted was relative to um some of the other remaining yellow recommendations that we had a couple of them very much relate to where we are current state in the new regulations around the growth requirements and so we're going to let that play out um and then as far as recommendations related to covid uh impacted uh recommend

[03:09:18] or related recommendations most of the topics that would be of consideration are likely going be handled through other mediums or platforms does that sound so what we'll expect to uh receive is uh kind of a like i said a copy of the technical edits we'll use this these next few weeks once or once we get that we'll use this time between now and next time we need to absorb that and we'll use the time at our next committee meeting to to really get some concurrence or any

[03:09:53] more clarity we need on those as far as that's concerned any questions recommendations any recommendations that anybody that that you do not see on here that which i'm surprised that we i didn't capture all these i'm not being credit for this i really thank emily for helping me pull this all together. All right.

[03:10:24] - I think we can, I know that we want to wait to have a discussion with Dr. Duran on the slide. - That was the other one. - Definition, but I also think we, a staff can kind of convene and talk through some possible scenarios. So potentially we can bring a couple options to the committee and we can also talk to Dr. Duran in the interim to get his feedback on that point and I'd talk to them about it and I want to talk to all of it.

[03:10:51] - Okay, but before we wrap up, from a timeline standpoint and where we are as a committee and relative to the things that we have on the table today um you and i talked about possibly being in a position to really kind of wrap this up by the end of the summer we still feel comfortable with that based on the discussion today i think so i think we can um actually provide the red line document for the technical edits in short order uh for you all i won't send it tonight you don't have to read it tonight but i'll probably send it to you all next week um so that you have plenty of time to digest

[03:11:29] to get us questions so that we can address those um at the july meeting we can walk through that document with you um do we have any questions there um and i think potentially a july meeting and certainly august if we need to but i think we could probably wrap this up with some kind of recommendations in july to bring to the board in september and you know we want to do the first and

[03:11:55] second reviews okay well i thank you again for everybody's uh input and and and for the department support in this uh committee's work as we've been saying all day it's been good to see everybody in 3d and so i will conclude the meeting with the committee thank you thank you okay